Best of Ireland & Scotland

Welcome & Tour Tips

Good to have you here — this page fills in the detail behind the welcome email, with everything worth knowing before we meet in Dublin.

Not everything here will be new to you — think of this as a quick refresher before travelling. Use the navigation below to jump to any section.

This is a personal guide from your Travel Director — for your official itinerary and inclusions, refer to your Trafalgar documents.

✈️ Before you travel

- 📍 Know your hotel and Day 1 meeting time from your welcome email
- ✈️ Know how you're getting from the airport to the hotel before you leave home
- 🎒 Keep your essentials (medication, chargers, etc.) in a small day bag — not in the bottom of your suitcase

📍 Know where to be

Your welcome email confirms our Dublin hotel and Day 1 timings. Aim to be in the hotel lobby/reception area for the first group meet-up listed in your welcome email.

🕐 First group meeting

Please be in the hotel lobby/reception area at 5:00 PM, ready for the Welcome Dinner.

Before 5:00 PM is usually arrival and settle-in time: check in (or store bags if early), freshen up, and acclimatise at your own pace. Just plan to be back in the lobby on time for our group start.

🏨 Hotel check-in

Check-in is typically after 3:00 PM.

If you arrive earlier, reception can usually store your main luggage until your room is ready, so it helps to keep essentials in a small day bag.

Many people arrive well before check-in, including those on the morning transfers. After dropping your bags, use the time to acclimatise at your own pace.

✈️ Airport transfers

Trafalgar offers complimentary Day 1 airport transfers at set times. Please check your joining documents and welcome email for timings and meeting details.

After collecting your luggage, follow signs for Arrivals and enter the main arrivals hall. Your Trafalgar host will arrive a few minutes before each departure — look out for them and introduce yourself when they arrive.

If you have booked a private transfer through Trafalgar, those details are listed separately in your documents. If you are not using those transfers, official taxis from the airport are safe and easy to find.

🧭 Airport meeting points — complimentary transfers only

Open these first — they show the two meeting landmarks in the public arrivals area (after baggage reclaim and customs) for Day 1 complimentary Trafalgar transfers only.

T1 photo T2 photo

T1: In the arrivals hall after customs, look left for ICE Currency Exchange (landside) — not the counter inside baggage reclaim.

T2: In the arrivals hall after customs, look straight ahead for the yellow sculpture.

If you are on a private transfer, please follow the details in your joining documents instead.

📝 Before you travel

This tour starts in Dublin and ends in Scotland. A quick check of your joining details before you travel usually makes Day 1 feel much easier.

✅ Check your joining details

Your welcome email and official documents confirm your Dublin hotel, Day 1 meeting time and complimentary airport transfer times. Keep those details easy to access in case you need them.

✈️ Arrival plan

- Check your latest airline updates.
- Confirm how you are getting from the airport to the hotel — Trafalgar transfer, private transfer or taxi.
- **Private transfer booked?** If your arrival time changes, update your transfer provider. If it was booked through Trafalgar, contact European Guest Services using the contact details in your welcome email.
- Complimentary transfers run at set times and cannot be held.
- If you miss your transfer, don't worry — taxis from Dublin Airport are easy to find and the hotel is straightforward to reach.

🎒 Keep essentials accessible

Have your passport, wallet, phone, charger and any medications easy to reach rather than buried in your suitcase.

Entry & travel documents: Entry and visa requirements can vary depending on your nationality. Your Trafalgar documents include guidance, and I recommend checking your government's official travel advice before departure to be safe.

🚌 On the coach

The coach will be our moving base between destinations. A few simple habits help keep things comfortable, safe and pleasant for everyone travelling together.

🔁 **Seat rotation** happens daily. I will explain the system clearly on Day One.

🚻 There is often a **WC on board**, and we also plan regular comfort stops along the way.

🪜 **Mobility & boarding:** There are steps when getting on and off the coach, so please take your time and use the handrail.

🛳️ This itinerary includes **ferry crossings**, so it helps to keep a layer and anything essential in your day bag rather than packed in your suitcase.

🥪 **Snacks are absolutely fine.** For general comfort and safety on a moving vehicle, it's best to avoid hot food and hot drinks while on the coach.

🎒 Bring a **small day bag** with what you may need during the day. Main suitcases stay in the coach hold until hotel arrival on travel days.

💼 **Carry-on space on the coach is limited.** Smaller soft bags such as backpacks or tote-style bags work best overhead or under the seat. Wheel-based carry-on suitcases usually do not fit well in the racks above. They are best avoided as on-board bags.

🔔 **Seatbelts:** For your safety, please ensure your seatbelt is fastened whenever you are seated and keep it on throughout the journey.

🧼 Please be mindful of **general hygiene**. Clean hands and common sense go a long way in shared spaces. If you feel unwell, wear a mask and keep some distance where appropriate.

🎒 What to pack

Most people find they pack more than they actually use. Comfortable, practical and easy to manage tends to win every time on this tour.

Essentials

- 👟 Comfortable walking shoes
- 🧥 Layered clothing for changing conditions
- ☔ A waterproof jacket
- 🎒 A small day bag
- 🔌 A UK Type G plug adapter (three rectangular prongs) View plug type
- 🎧 Optional: wired headphones with a 3.5mm jack to use with our walking-tour audio devices

Packing smarter

- 💼 Think practical rather than "just in case" — and leave a little room for things you pick up along the way.
- 🌦️ Layers are key — weather can change quickly, and it is not unusual to experience several conditions in one day.
- 💧 Optional: bring a reusable drink bottle, but avoid bulky bottles — collapsible or slim styles are easiest to carry on coach days.
- 💡 Good shoes and a waterproof jacket you trust will do most of the heavy lifting on this tour.

🎒 **Luggage allowance:** 1 suitcase (max 23kg / 50lbs) plus 1 soft hand-luggage bag. The hand-luggage bag should be soft-sided (backpack/tote style), without wheels or a telescopic handle. Label your bags clearly before arrival and pack so you can manage your own luggage for short distances when needed.

💡 **Tip:** Because suitcase delivery can take around 30 minutes, keep any toiletries, medications or arrival essentials you may need straight away in your hand luggage.

🧺 **Laundry:** On a tour of this length, people are usually glad to know there is a chance to do a bit of laundry at some point. We can normally manage that at our two-night stops, most often Killarney and Glasgow, usually through the hotel as a service wash rather than dry cleaning, which tends to be the more affordable option.

What to expect from the weather

Weather across Ireland and Scotland can shift across regions and within a few hours. Forecasts are useful, but flexibility helps most.

A practical reality

You might get a bit of everything in one day, which is fairly normal here. A couple of flexible layers will usually serve you better than worrying too much about the forecast.

What usually helps

Treat forecasts as a guide rather than a guarantee, and expect occasional changes to pace or stop timing when conditions shift.

But honestly — don't let the forecast worry you too much. We adapt to whatever comes our way, and some of the best moments happen in between the raindrops.

"Today's rain is tomorrow's whisky."
– A local favourite in both Scotland and Ireland

📲 Staying connected on tour

I use WhatsApp for reminders and day-to-day updates while we are travelling. Joining is optional, and it works alongside your official documents and welcome email.

1. Download WhatsApp before you travel if you do not already use it — either from the link below or directly from your phone's app store.

   💬 **Download WhatsApp**

2. Set up your profile and verify your number.

3. Save my number in your phone from the welcome email or with the links above.

4. Send me a quick WhatsApp message with your name so I know you are set up before the tour begins.

👫 **Travelling with someone?** It helps if both of you message me, just in case phones get separated during the trip.

Most hotels and many public places offer free Wi-Fi. If you plan to rely on mobile data, it is worth checking roaming options with your provider before travel. Some people choose to use an eSIM as a simple alternative for staying connected across multiple countries.

💼 Practical notes

A few practical notes that tend to come up — worth a quick read before you travel.

🚦 The pace of the tour

This is a 15-day journey across Ireland, Northern Ireland and Scotland. There is good variety and some breathing room, but a few days still involve early starts, ferries or longer distances.

🚶 Walking

Expect uneven streets, stairs, city walking and days where comfortable shoes matter more than style points.

🏨 Hotel styles vary

Across Ireland and Scotland we use a mix of modern and historic properties. Room sizes and layouts can vary.

🌀 Air conditioning at hotels

You will have the comfort of air conditioning on the coach and in many museums, restaurants and public spaces. However, the UK and Ireland are not especially known for hot weather, so many hotels in this region do not have full air conditioning. If your room feels warm, ask reception whether a portable fan is available.

🍽️ Included meals

Breakfast is included daily and some dinners are provided. On included meal days, timings are set to keep the itinerary running smoothly, so punctuality is appreciated.

👥 Travelling as a group

Touring as a group works best when everyone is mindful of shared timings — I will make sure things run smoothly from my end.

👮 Your Driver

Your Driver plays a key role in both the safety and smooth running of each day. Driving hours are legally regulated, so it helps everyone if we are ready to depart at the agreed time.

💳 Money & payments

Card payments are widely accepted throughout the UK and Ireland, though carrying a small amount of cash is still useful — especially at stops where cards may not be accepted, and for gratuities such as Local Specialists who join us for sightseeing.

The simplest option is usually to withdraw a small amount from an ATM/cash machine, as exchange counters are limited outside major airports and often charge higher rates or commission.

Optional experiences can be paid by card or cash.

💶 Gratuities

Some gratuities are included in your tour price — restaurant staff and hotel porters, for example. Tips for your Travel Director and Driver are separate unless pre-paid.

If you have pre-paid — thank you, it is genuinely appreciated.

Guidance on appropriate amounts is in your Trafalgar documents — or just ask me on tour.

If you are unsure whether gratuities are pre-paid, check your tour voucher or booking confirmation. It can still help to carry a little cash for day-to-day convenience.

💷 Currency

Ireland uses the Euro (€). Northern Ireland and Scotland use Pounds Sterling (£).

🚻 Toilets

Some public facilities may require coins or small payment, so keeping a little cash handy can occasionally help.

🔒 Security

Keep passports, cards and valuables secure. Pickpocketing is not common, but just stay aware of your belongings in busy spots.

⭐ Optional experiences

Your tour already includes a lot — but optionals are worth knowing about. These are experiences that go a little deeper in certain places. Convenient, good value, and everything is organised for you.

These are not generic extras — they are hand-picked experiences that suit the pace and places of this particular tour. Most people who do them wish they had booked more.

Optional experiences are priced separately so people who want them can choose them, and people who prefer a quieter pace are not paying for something they would not use.
I will walk you through what is available once we are underway. There is never any pressure.

☎️ Important contact details

Save these before you travel — they are harder to find when you are already on the move.

Joel Plunkett

Phone / WhatsApp

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WhatsApp is usually the easiest way to reach me during the trip.

📷 **Follow along on Instagram →**

🌍 **Visit my homepage →**

✉️ **Email me →**

Questions before the tour?

Before our tour begins, I may not always be able to reply immediately, especially if I am with another group, but I will always reply as soon as I can.

🚨 **Urgent or time-sensitive before departure?**
For anything that needs immediate attention before Day 1, please check your welcome email for European Guest Services contact details.

For peace of mind, save my number and European Guest Services now, and keep your official joining instructions somewhere easy to find before departure.

✨ Final note

During the tour, if you are ever unsure about anything, just ask. There is very little I have not come across before.
🍀 See you in Dublin.

Want this page offline? Click here to print or save as PDF — or press Cmd+P (Mac) / Ctrl+P (Windows) and choose "Save as PDF". On mobile, use the link.

A personal guide from your Travel Director. For official timings, inclusions and operational details before the tour, refer to your Trafalgar documents.